

LICENSE TO FLY

This pilot's certificate was issued to a British officer by the Royal Aero Club in 1916. Pilots fresh from flight training had a low survival rate at the front — at the height of the fighting their average life-expectancy could be as low as two to three weeks.



MEN AND MACHINES

A Royal Air Force squadron is pictured at its base in northern France in 1918. The airmen are in flying gear; as usual, the ground crew are relegated to the background. The aircraft are Royal Aircraft Factory S.E.5as, probably the best British fighter of the war.